Key steps for strong short response writing

1. **Start with a clear main point**

Short responses must begin with the answer, not background. Use direct sentence starters such as: *"Article 3 emphasises that..." "Self-determination refers to..."*

2. **Explain the key concept briefly**

Define or clarify the concept (e.g., self-determination, holistic health, cultural determinants) in your own words before applying it. This prevents vague or incorrect use of terms.

3. **Link the concept to UNDRIP Article 3**

Show clearly how the concept relates to the rights described in Article 3 and to Australian Indigenous Peoples' understandings of health and wellbeing. Interpret the connection—do not retell general background information.

4. Use scholarly or unit evidence

Short responses require academic grounding. Evidence may include:

- unit concepts
- cultural determinants
- colonisation frameworks
- peer-reviewed literature
- Keep evidence brief and purposeful.

5. **Write concisely and coherently**

Use short, direct sentences to improve clarity and reduce grammatical errors. Avoid long introductions, unnecessary detail, or narrative writing.

6. **Maintain respectful terminology**

Use correct and consistent terms such as *Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Peoples*. Avoid deficit language and ensure cultural safety.

7. **Conclude by linking back to the question**

End with a sentence that reinforces your main point and signals relevance to the marker. Do not introduce new information.

8. **Avoid common pitfalls** - Watch for:

- over-description
- missing the main point
- weak or unclear links to Article 3
- lack of evidence
- incorrect terminology
- overly long or complex sentences
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9. **Use postgraduate verbs**

Choose verbs that show analysis and interpretation: analyse, interpret, examine, integrate, contextualise. Avoid vague verbs like *talk about* or *discuss*.

10. **Follow a simple structure (PEEL)**

Point → Explain → Evidence → Link

This keeps the paragraph focused, analytical, and academically grounded.